

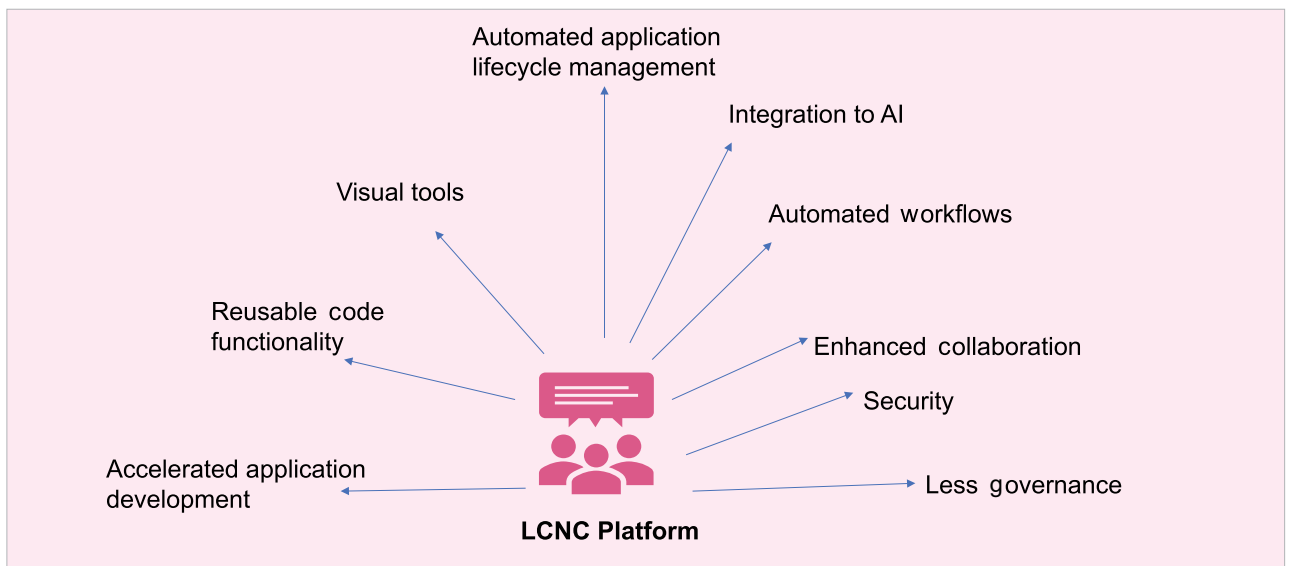


Figure 1: LCNC platform characteristics

Key characteristics of LCNC platforms

LCNC platforms enable developers to quickly build applications by leveraging a library of pre-built components, such as user interfaces, databases, and APIs. Check Figure 1 for the key characteristics of these platforms.

Some of the most common characteristics are:

- Accelerated application development and a drag-and-drop interface, which allows creation of applications by using flow charts and other diagrams. These platforms democratise development as there is no need of experience and training to build effective custom apps.
- Reusable code functionality, which saves time as users don't need to re-create core components.
- Visual tools for personalised and seamless user experiences.
- Automated application lifecycle management, covering rapid application development, debugging, staging, and deployment.
- Integration with AI helps streamline processes and automate decision-making.
- Automated workflows and decision-making processes help

in optimising productivity and reducing manual efforts.

- Authentication processes and data encryption services enhance security.
- LCNC development simplifies the cognitive load and timing pressures on developers, potentially reducing the need for governance.

Key LCNC platforms

The LCNC market is populated by several key players in the proprietary and open source domains.

Proprietary platforms

Major proprietary platform vendors for LCNC are SAP, Appian, Google Appsheet, Mendix, Pegasystems, Outsystems, Zoho Creator, Microsoft PowerApps, HCL Volt MX, Salesforce, ServiceNow, etc. Some of these proprietary platforms are briefly explained below.

Salesforce: Salesforce includes all the tools for creating business apps. Users can publish apps to app stores using the platform's Mobile Publisher.

Microsoft Power Apps: This platform helps to create rich web and mobile apps. It is built on Microsoft's Common Data Service.

Appian: This low-code platform focuses on automating complex

workflows. It helps users build BPM (business process management) apps -- for example, robotic process automation, case management, and document management. The platform also provides pre-built connectors to merge with other apps.

Service Now: With its great app structure, this platform allows anyone to automate, extend, and build digital workflows. It eases app creation for different business operations.

HCL Volt MX: Volt MX is a full-stack application development and runtime platform. It implements classic model-view-controller architecture with a clear separation of presentation, logic, and data, allowing architectural interoperability with traditional software engineering approaches.

OutSystems: This platform focuses on creating web and mobile apps that are high-performance and scalable. It is used for modernising legacy applications.

Mendix: Mendix supports enterprise app development, cross-platform mobile development, legacy application modernisation, and process automation. It helps in securely integrating data and logic from external sources and legacy systems.